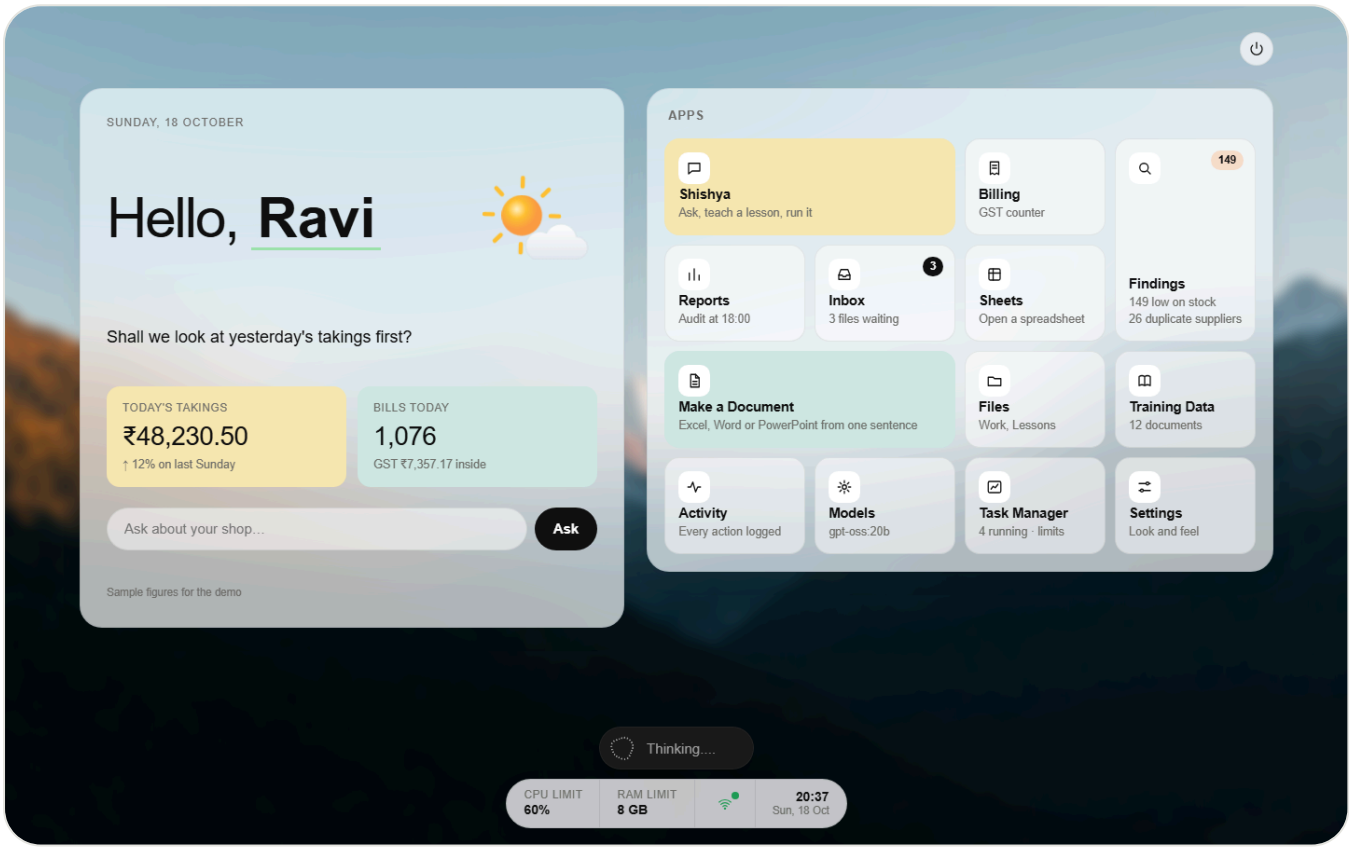
SHISHYA · शिष्य

Home screen design guide

How the new home screen looks and why: the palette, type, layout, every component, how it behaves, and a ranked list of what to improve next.



Status
Web demo, approved direction. Not yet wired to the app.

Source
`web/home.html`, one file plus `web/wallpaper.jpg` and `web/vendor/`

Target
The Windows .exe (and the Mac build), light theme only, works offline

01

The idea in one line

A calm, flat desk for a shop owner: one glance shows today's money, what needs attention, and that the AI is working safely on this laptop.

Who it is for

The owner of a single-branch pharmacy or shop, at a busy counter, often on an older laptop, sometimes reading in Hindi or Telugu. Every decision below is judged against that person, not against a design award.

Five principles

1. **Flat first.** Solid shapes, clear edges, no gradients or glow on content. Depth is used only to separate layers: the photo, the frosted panels, and the content on them.
2. **Pastel marks importance.** Butter and mint are not decoration. They mark the two things that matter most in each panel: today's figures and the main apps.
3. **Numbers are the heroes.** Large, tabular figures (₹48,230.50, 1,076) with a one-line explanation under each.
4. **Trust is visible.** The network state, the resource limits and what the AI is doing are always on screen, in the dock. They are controls, not decoration.
5. **Calm by default.** One photo, softly blurred. Motion only where something is happening: the orb, the weather, a hover.

Style decisions already made

DECISION	WHY
Flat design, not glass, neumorphism or skeuomorphism	Best contrast and readability at a counter, cheapest to draw while a local AI model is using most of the machine, and matches Windows 11 and macOS.
Mica (frosted glass) on the panels and dock only	Lets the wallpaper show through without hurting text, because the content inside the panels stays solid.
Light theme only	One look to design, test and support. Dark mode was removed on purpose; see the improvements list for when to revisit.
A real photo, blurred 6 px	Gives the screen warmth and place; the blur stops it competing with the content.
Everything bundled locally	The app must work with the network switched off. No fonts, libraries or images load from the internet.

02

Colour

All colours are defined once as tokens at the top of `home.html` (the `:root` block). Change a token and every component that uses it follows. Never type a colour directly into a component.

Surfaces and text

Page
`--page #F3F3F0`
Behind everything, if the photo fails

Card
`--card #FFFFFF`
Icon chips, popovers

Mica
`--mica 250,251,252 @ 70%`
Panels, + 48 px blur

Orb pill
`#1A1A1A`
Text `#A3A3A3`

Ink
`--ink #121212`
Headings, numbers, Ask button

Ink 2
`--ink-2 #6E6E6A`
Labels, explanations

Ink 3
`--ink-3 #A3A39E`
Ticks only. Too light for text

Line
`--line black @ 7%`
Borders, dividers

Pastels and meaning

Butter
`--butter #F8E7B0`
The main app, today's takings

Mint
`--mint #CDE8E3`
Second priority, selected item

Peach
`--peach #F9DCCB`
Warning badges (149 low stock)

Green, soft
`--accent-2 #9BE5AE`
Name underline, fills

Green
`--accent #1F9D55`
On, selected, safe (Locked)

Amber
`--warn #B87800`
Network open (Browsing, SSH)

Red
`--bad #C8321E`
Shut down, refused

Sun
`#FFC233 → #FD9D45`
Weather art only

Rules

At most one butter and one mint item per panel, or they stop meaning "important". Green, amber and red are reserved for state (safe, open, danger) and never used for decoration. Text on pastels is always Ink or Ink 2, never white.

03

Type and layout

Typeface

Helvetica Neue, falling back to Helvetica, Arial Nova, then Arial. On Windows this usually renders as Arial, which is close enough at these sizes. One family throughout; hierarchy comes from size and weight.

Hello, **Ravi**

ROLE	SIZE	WEIGHT	NOTES
Greeting	36–60 px (scales)	500, name 700	Letter-spacing −0.035em; name underlined 3 px soft green
Big figures	28 px	500	Tabular numbers so digits line up
Line of the day	18 px	400	Ten lines rotate, one per day
Body, tile names	14.5–15 px	600 names	Tile names bold, descriptions regular
Orb pill text	15 px	500	Grey #A3A3A3 on dark, four dots: "Thinking...."
Labels (eyebrows)	11.5–13 px	600	Uppercase, letter-spacing 0.04–0.08em

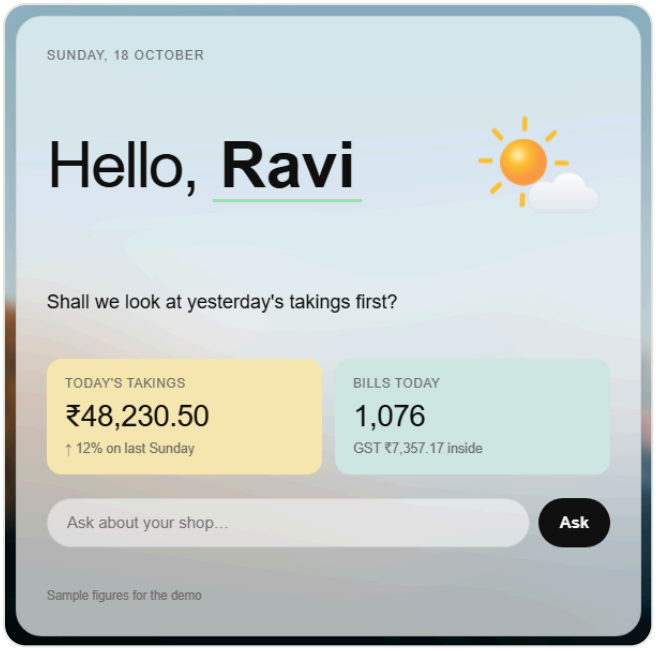
Layout

- **Two panels** side by side, widths 1 : 1.15, max 1280 px wide, 24 px gap and gutters.
- **App grid:** 4 columns, 104 px rows, 10 px gaps, packed densely so no holes appear. Wide tiles span 2 columns; Findings spans 2 rows.
- **Dock:** fixed, centred at the bottom, with the orb pill 10 px above it. Power button alone at top right.
- **Under 900 px wide** the panels stack and the grid drops to 2 columns.

SHAPE	CORNER RADIUS
Panels (greeting, apps)	24 px
App tiles	16 px
Figure cards	14 px
Icon chips	10 px
Dock, pills, buttons, input	fully round

04

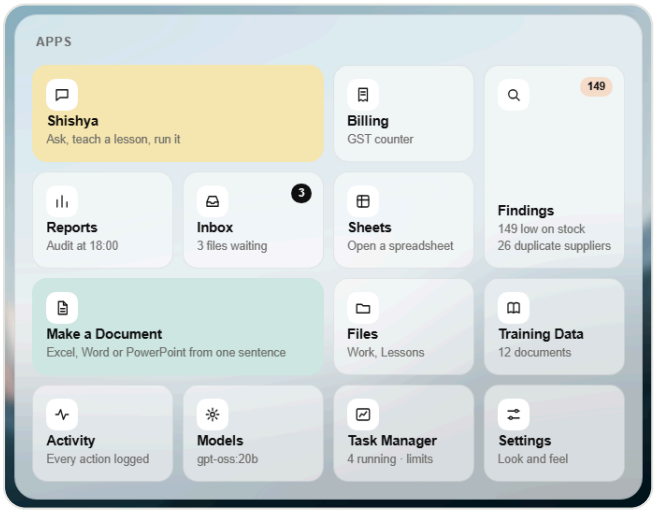
Components



Greeting card

Greeting card

- **Date** as an uppercase eyebrow.
- **"Hello, Ravi"**. Click the name to switch user (owner Ravi, clerk Priya). In the app this comes from the login.
- **Weather art**: a drawn sun with slowly turning rays and a cloud. Clear, Cloudy, Rain and Snow each change the art, and rain or snow also falls gently across the screen.
- **Line of the day**: ten friendly prompts, one per day of the year.
- **Two figure cards**, butter then mint: today's takings and bills today, each with a one-line explanation.
- **Ask box**: a round input with a black Ask button. Asking starts the orb's searching → solving → composing run.



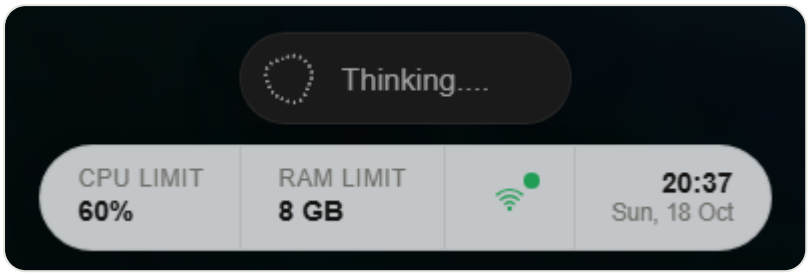
Apps panel

Apps panel

- 13 tiles: icon chip, bold name, one-line status that says something live ("3 files waiting", "Audit at 18:00").
- **Shishya** (butter, wide) is the front door. **Make a Document** (mint, wide) is the second.
- **Findings** is tall because it carries two facts.
- Badges: black for counts, peach for warnings.
- Hover lifts a tile 2 px; press shrinks it slightly.

04 · CONTINUED

The dock and the orb



Orb pill above the dock

PART	WHAT IT DOES	IN THE REAL APP
Orb pill	Dark capsule with a 32 px animated dot orb and the current verb. Click it to see all nine states: Working, Searching, Solving, Listening, Connecting, Weaving, Composing, Thinking (idle), Shaping.	Follows what the AI is actually doing.
CPU limit	Opens a sideways dial, 10–100% in steps of 10. The chosen number sits in the centre in green; numbers fade with distance. Scroll, drag, click or use arrow keys.	Caps the sandbox's processor use (Windows job object).
RAM limit	The same dial, 2–16 GB. Notes that the AI model needs about 7 GB.	Caps the sandbox's memory.
Network	A Wi-Fi icon: green when locked, amber when open. Opens a vertical wheel: Locked, Browsing, SSH.	Starts sandboxed apps with or without network permission. Every change is logged.
Clock	Time and short date.	Same.
Power (top right)	Asks before shutting down, in the page itself.	Stops the sandbox.

Motion

- Orb: always moving gently; speed comes from the library's tuned presets.
- Sun rays turn once every 40 seconds. Rain and snow are drawn on one canvas.
- Popovers fade and rise 8 px over 0.2 s. Tiles lift on hover.
- With "reduce motion" switched on in Windows, all of this stops and the orb shows a still frame.

Wallpaper

An alpine valley photo at dawn, saved as `web/wallpaper.jpg` (2000 × 1125, 159 KB), blurred 6 px and scaled 4% so the blur's soft edge never shows.

05

How it is built

FILE	WHAT IT IS
`web/home.html`	The whole screen: tokens, styles, markup and script in one file. No build step.
`web/wallpaper.jpg`	The background photo.
`web/vendor/thinking-orbs/`	The orb drawing engine from Libraries.dev, v0.3.2, MIT licence. Only the framework-free engine is included, so no React is needed.
`docs/design/`	This guide's source and its images.

How to change things safely

- **A colour:** edit the token in the `:root` block. Do not add new colours inside components.
- **A tile:** copy an existing `<button class="tile">`. Add `wide` or `tall` to change its size. Keep the total so the grid fills without holes.
- **The wallpaper:** replace `wallpaper.jpg` with any landscape photo about 2000 px wide and under 300 KB. Darker photos need a stronger Mica (raise the 70% in `--mica`).
- **The orb's states:** the labels live in the `LABEL` list in the last script block.
- **The dial ranges:** in the `DIALS` list (CPU 10–100 by 10, RAM 2–16 by 1).
- **The daily lines:** in the `LINES` list (ten lines).

Still demo-only

Takings, bills, tile statuses, weather, CPU and RAM values and the network switch are sample data. Clicking a tile only shows a message. Wiring each one to the real app is the next engineering step.

06

What to improve next

Ranked by how much each matters to a shop owner at the counter. HIGH before the December submission, MEDIUM if there is time, LATER after.

PRIORITY	ISSUE	SUGGESTED FIX
HIGH	Hindi and Telugu text may show as boxes	Helvetica and Arial have no Devanagari or Telugu letters. Bundle Noto Sans Devanagari and Noto Sans Telugu in `web/fonts/` and add them to the font stack.
HIGH	Weather needs the internet, but the sandbox is offline	Fetch it on the host side only (outside the sandbox), cache it, and fall back to a time-of-day sun or moon when offline. Never let the sandbox fetch it.
HIGH	Lower part of the panels turns grey over the dark mountains	Add a light gradient inside the Mica panels (more white towards the bottom) or raise `--mica` to 78%.
HIGH	Blur and frosted glass can be slow on old laptops	Save a pre-blurred copy of the wallpaper instead of blurring live, and fall back to solid panels when Windows "transparency effects" are off.
MEDIUM	Empty space in the greeting card between the name and the line of the day	Tighten the gap, or use it for "next up" (the 18:00 audit, approvals waiting).
MEDIUM	Findings tile has empty space at the top	Add a tiny bar chart of low-stock items by category.
MEDIUM	Dock labels are small (11.5 px)	Raise to 12.5–13 px; the counter is read from arm's length.
MEDIUM	Orb pill and dock are two separate pieces	Try joining them into one bar, or slide the pill out of the dock only while the AI works.
MEDIUM	The dials only accept dragging and clicking	Let people type a number too, and show the current usage next to the limit.
MEDIUM	Tiles look clickable but do nothing yet	Wire each to its app and show a loading state on the orb while it opens.
LATER	No dark theme	Revisit only if owners use it at night. Design it fresh rather than inverting colours.
LATER	One wallpaper	Offer three or four, plus a plain colour for video calls (moving or busy backgrounds blur on screen-share).
LATER	Phone layout only lightly checked	Test at 400 px wide; the dock needs a two-row version.
LATER	Keyboard shortcuts	For example `/` to jump to Ask, `L` for the network lock.

Checklist before every change ships

- Readable from arm's length, on the darkest part of the wallpaper.
- Uses existing tokens only; no new colours.
- Works with the network off.
- Works with "reduce motion" on.
- Checked at 1280 × 800 and 1920 × 1080, and on the Mac.
- Every control reachable with the keyboard, with a visible focus ring.